No.	Preparation	Capability	Score
1	**Deafferented air stepping**	Intrinsic rhythm; feedback off	Rhythm and swing (rhythm-gated)
2	**Afferented air stepping**	Heel, toe, and load feedback active	Rhythm and swing (rhythm-gated)
3	**Standing balance**	Posture under push perturbations	Posture maintenance under push
4	**Ground walking**	Ground contact and forward gait	Kinematics vs. human reference cycle
5	**Contact-driven ground walking**	Contact-driven pathway variant	Kinematics vs. human reference cycle

Each winner seeds the next stage. Finalists undergo perturbation and basin checks. Air stages are suspended; ground evaluations retain the support harness.